

[Home](#) » [KB](#) » [SysAdmin](#) » How to Switch from Zsh to Bash on Mac

How to Switch from Zsh to Bash on Mac

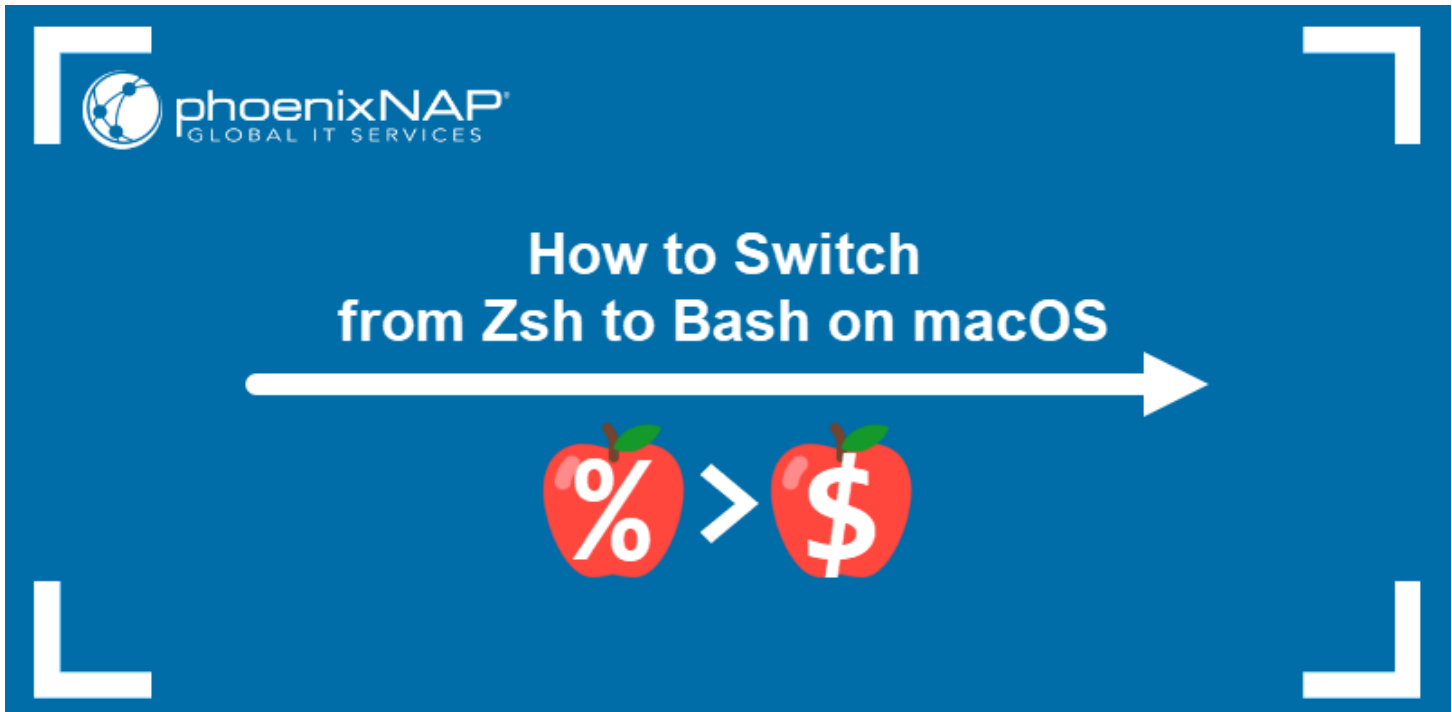


By [Marko Aleksic](#) – Published: December 19, 2025

Topics: [Bash](#), [Macos](#)

Zsh replaced Bash as macOS's default **terminal shell** in macOS Catalina. While Zsh is in many ways superior to Bash, thanks to its floating-point support, hash **data structures**, customization options, etc., there are still use cases where Bash may be helpful in the macOS terminal.

This article teaches you how to switch to Bash from Zsh on macOS using CLI and System Settings.



Prerequisites

- macOS Catalina or later.
- Administrative access to the system.

How to Check What Shell Mac Is Using?

If you are unsure about which shell you are using, open the terminal application and enter the following **ps command**:

```
ps -p $$
```

The output shows the active shell process. The **CMD** column shows the name of the currently running shell.



How to Change Zsh to Bash on Mac?

Change the default terminal shell in macOS using the **CLI** or the System Preferences **GUI**. The following sections explain both methods.

Via Terminal

Switching from Zsh to Bash in the terminal on macOS is a short, straightforward process.

Follow the steps below to replace Zsh with Bash:

1. View the list of available shells on the system by typing:

Move to Phoenix.
Scale Your IT without limits.

- Redundant power & cooling
- Carrier-neutral connectivity
- Compliance-ready with 24/7 support



Learn More



Contents

1. How to Check What Shell Mac Is Using?
2. How to Change Zsh to Bash on Mac?
 - 2.1. Via Terminal
 - 2.2. Via System Settings
3. How to Update Bash on Mac?

Subscribe to our newsletter

SUBSCRIBE

```
cat /etc/shells
```

- Find and note the path to the Bash executable in the list. Most often, the default Bash path is `/bin/bash`.

```
[marko@macbook ~ % cat /etc/shells
# List of acceptable shells for chpass(1).
# Ftpd will not allow users to connect who are not using
# one of these shells.

/bin/bash
/bin/csh
/bin/dash
/bin/ksh
/bin/sh
/bin/tcsh
/bin/zsh
marko@macbook ~ %
```

- Use the [`chsh` command](#) to change the currently running shell:

```
chsh -s [path-to-bash]
```

- Enter the administrative [`password`](#) when prompted.

```
[marko@macbook ~ % chsh -s /bin/bash
Changing shell for marko.
Password for marko: 
```

- Exit the terminal by entering:

```
exit
```

Next time you open the terminal, the Bash prompt appears along with a warning that Zsh is the default shell.

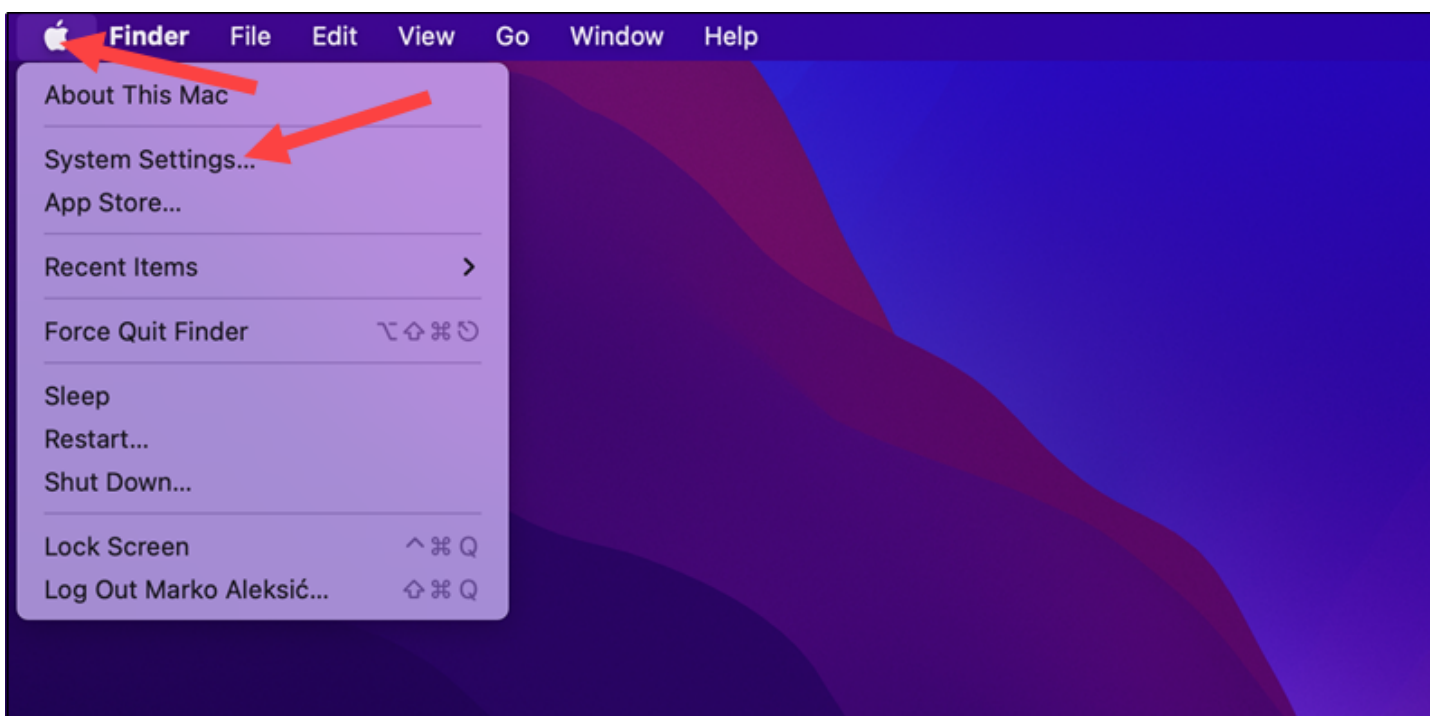
```
Last login: Mon Jul 31 10:19:50 on ttys000

The default interactive shell is now zsh.
To update your account to use zsh, please run `chsh -s /bin/zsh`.
For more details, please visit https://support.apple.com/kb/HT208050.
macbook:~ marko$
```

Via System Settings

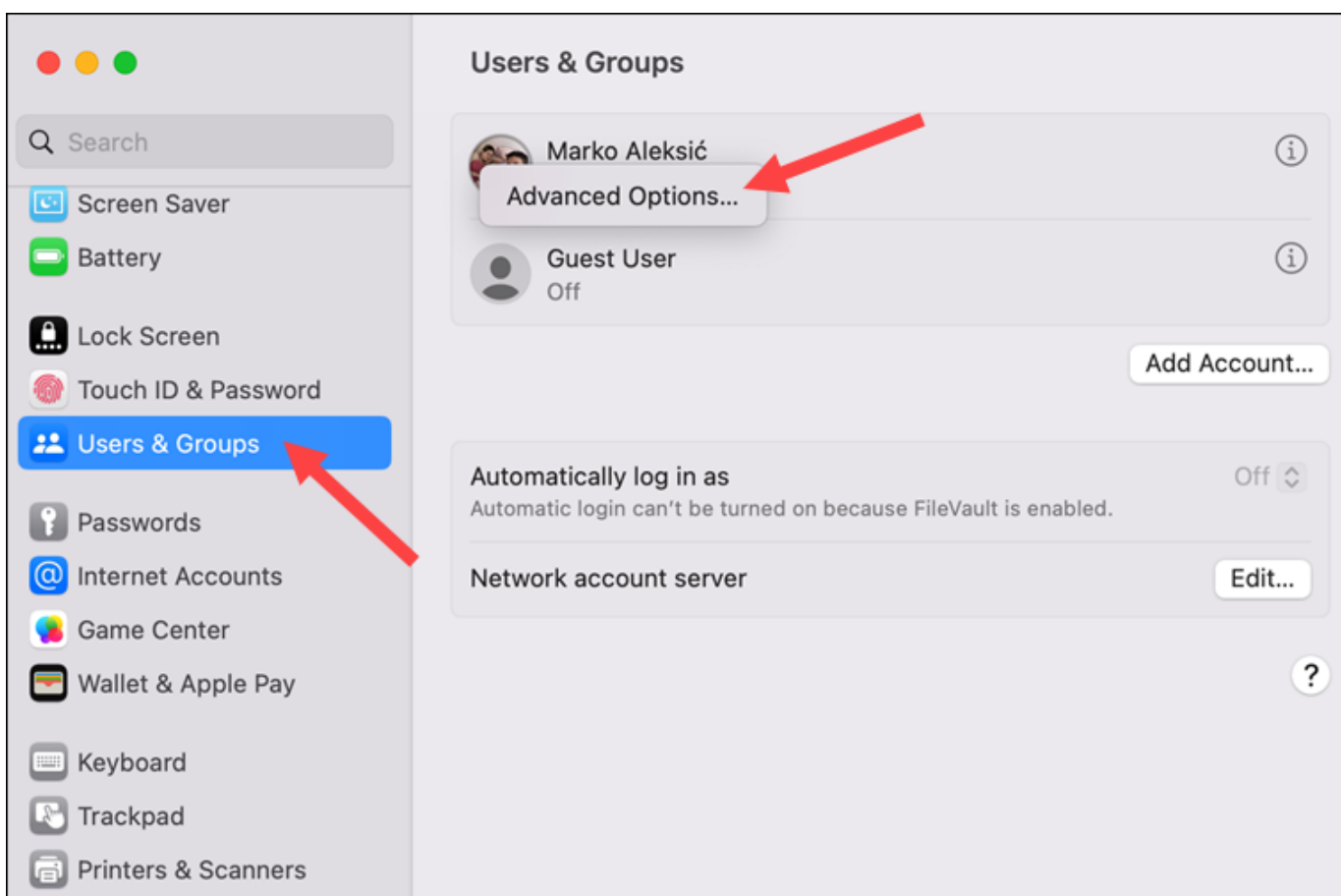
The System Settings app lets users access all critical system configuration options in one place. Follow the steps below to change the terminal shell using System Settings.

- Click the Apple logo, then select **System Settings** in the menu.

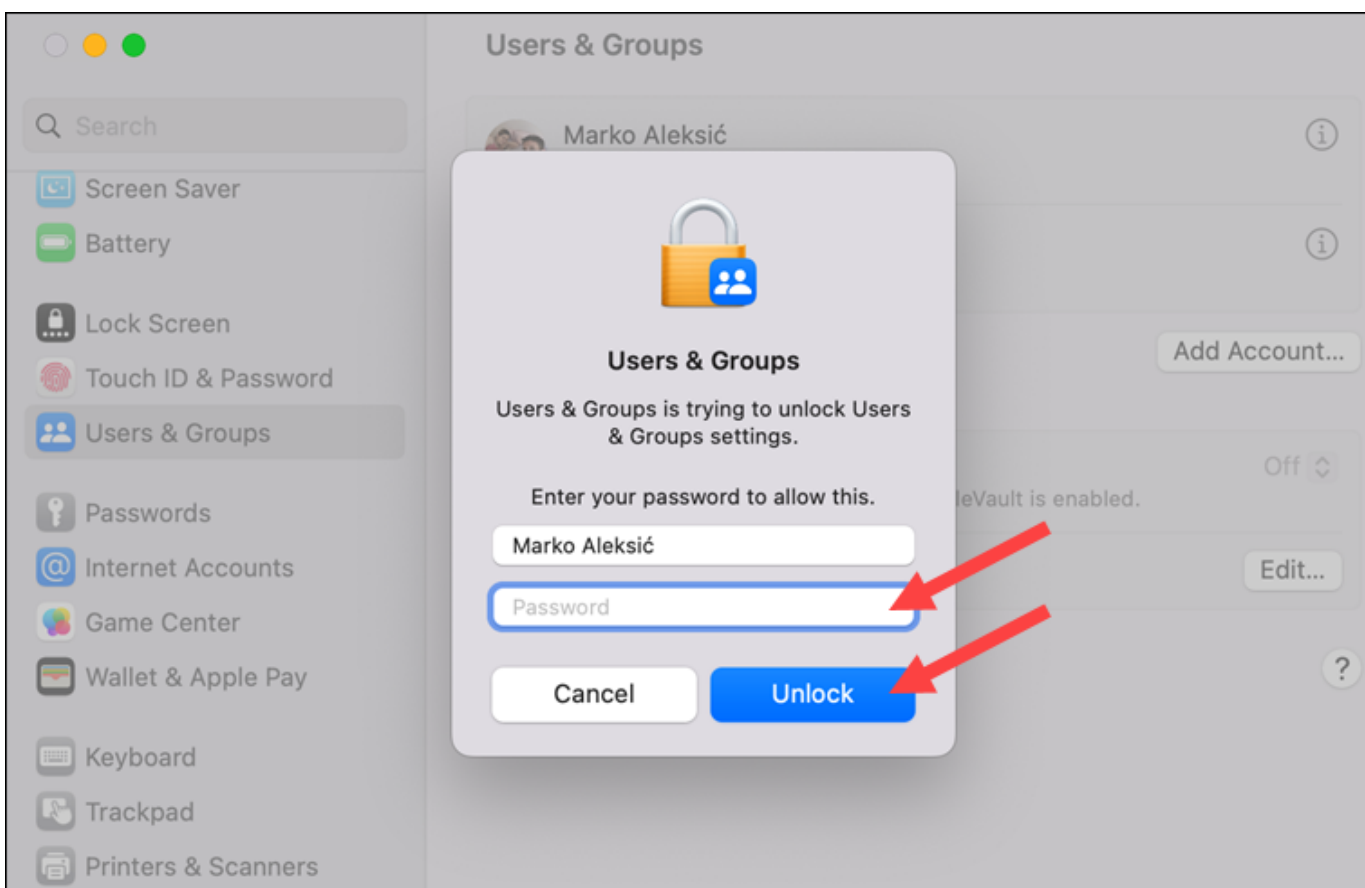


- Select the **Users & Groups** section in the menu on the left side of the window.

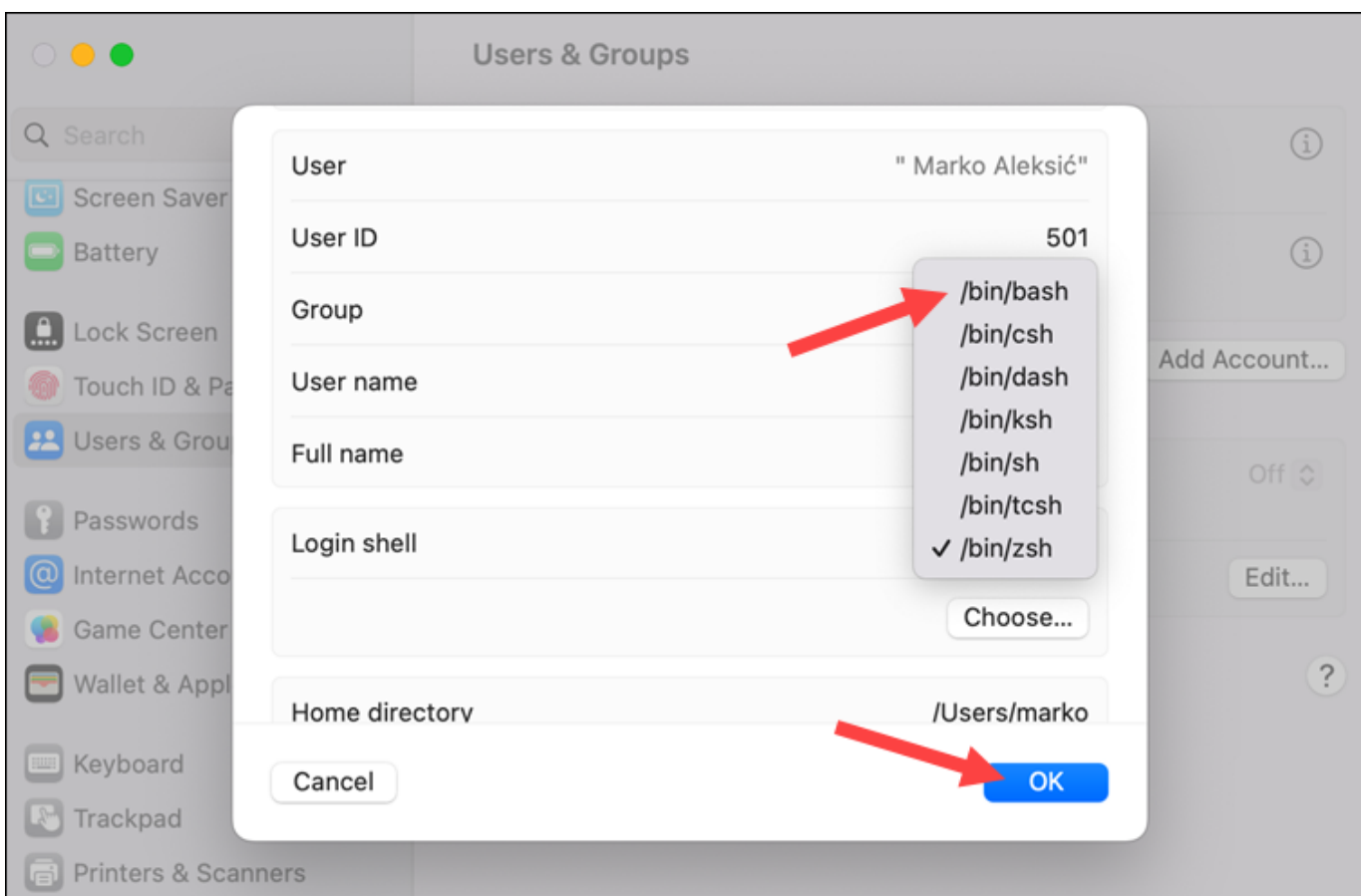
- Hold the **Control** key and select your user to show the **Advanced Options** item. Select the item to access more user-related options.



4. Type your password to confirm the administrative privileges for your user and select **Unlock**.



5. Expand the list of available shells and select the **/bin/bash** option. Confirm the selection by clicking **OK**.



Open the terminal and confirm that it is now running Bash.

How to Update Bash on Mac?

By default, macOS provides an outdated Bash version (Bash 3.2.57 from 2007). If you wish to install the latest version of Bash, use **Homebrew package manager**. Follow the steps below to install Bash with Homebrew.

1. Update and upgrade your Homebrew formulae:

```
brew upgrade
```

2. Install the Bash Homebrew formula:

```
brew install bash

[marko@macbook ~ % brew install bash
=> Downloading https://formulae.brew.sh/api/formula.jws.json
##### 100.0%
=> Downloading https://formulae.brew.sh/api/cask.jws.json
##### 100.0%
=> Fetching bash
=> Downloading https://ghcr.io/v2/homebrew/core/bash/manifests/5.2.15
##### 100.0%]
```

3. Reload the shell with the **exec command**:

```
exec bash
```

4. Add the Bash Homebrew installation path to the list of available shells:

```
echo $(brew --prefix)/bin/bash | sudo tee -a /private/etc/shells

[marko@macbook ~ % echo $(brew --prefix)/bin/bash | sudo tee -a /private/etc/shells
ls
>Password:
/opt/homebrew/bin/bash
marko@macbook ~ %]
```

5. Change the default shell with the **chsh** command:

```
chsh -s [path-to-bash]

[marko@macbook ~ % chsh -s /opt/homebrew/bin/bash
Changing shell for marko.
Password for marko: ]
```

Conclusion

The article showed you how to switch from Zsh to Bash on macOS. It also provided instructions for ensuring that your system runs the latest version of Bash.

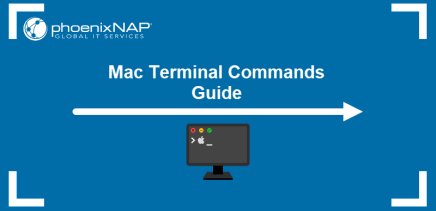
If you plan to use Bash to run scripts, check out our **Bash script** tutorial.

Was this article helpful?

Yes

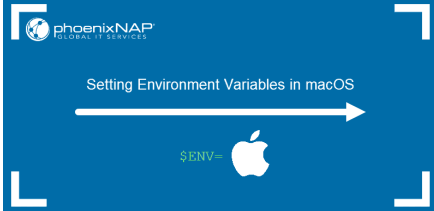
No

Next you should read



SysAdmin

Mac Terminal Commands



SysAdmin

How to Set Environment Variables in MacOS



DevOps and Development

How to Install Java on Mac



DevOps and Development, SysAdmin

How to Install Pip on Mac

CONTACT US

 **Get a Quote**
 **Support (1-855-330-1509)**
 **Sales (1-877-588-5918)**



COLOCATION

Phoenix
Ashburn
Amsterdam
Atlanta
Belgrade
Singapore
Shipping Instructions

RECENT POSTS

How to Find Standard Deviation in R
Git checkout Command Explained
AlmaLinux Vs. Ubuntu: Server OS Comparison
Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) in Bare Metal Cloud
Git: "failed to push some refs to" Error

SERVERS

Bare Metal Cloud
Dedicated Servers
Database Servers
Virtualization Servers
High Performance Computing (HPC) Servers
Dedicated Streaming Servers
Dedicated Game Servers
Dedicated Storage Servers
SQL Server Hosting
Dedicated Servers in Amsterdam
Cloud Servers in Europe
Big Memory Infrastructure

BUY NOW
BMC PORTAL

CLOUD SERVICES

Data Security Cloud
Managed Private Cloud
Object Storage

SOLUTIONS

Disaster Recovery
Web Hosting Reseller
SaaS Hosting

COMPLIANCE

HIPAA Ready Hosting
PCI Compliant Hosting
Privacy Center
Do not sell or share my personal information

NEEDS

Disaster Recovery Solutions
High Availability Solutions
Cloud Evaluation

INDUSTRIES

Web Hosting Providers
Legal
MSPs & VARs
Media Hosting
Online Gaming
SaaS Hosting Solutions
Ecommerce Hosting Solutions

COMPANY

About phoenixNAP
IaaS Solutions
Customer Experience
Platform
Schedule Virtual Tour
Open Source Community
Resource Library
Press
Events
Careers

PROMOTIONS

[Contact Us](#) [Legal](#) [Privacy Policy](#) [Terms of Use](#) [DMCA](#) [GDPR](#) [Sitemap](#) [Blog](#) [Resources](#) [Knowledge Base](#) [IT Glossary](#) [GitHub](#) [RFP Template](#)